

NYC DINNER STANDARD · NEW YORK CITY

Italian Trattoria *Dinner Service*

*Benchmarked against the 10 most iconic Italian restaurants
in New York City — from Carbone to Don Angie to Via Carota.*

Reference Restaurants: Carbone · Don Angie · Via Carota · I Sodi
Lilia · Emmett's · L'Artusi · Rezdôra · Barbuto · Cacio e Pepe

THE BENCHMARK

10 NYC Restaurants. One Standard.

These are the restaurants that define Italian dining in New York City right now. Not the tourist traps on Mulberry Street. The ones with 3-month waitlists, \$18 cacio e pepe, and regulars who fly in from LA just to eat there. This guide is built to that standard.

The Italian Trattoria — What It Really Means

Trattoria is not a restaurant category. It is a philosophy.

A trattoria feeds people the way a grandmother would — with generosity, intention, and zero pretension. The tablecloths are paper. The wine is in carafes. The pasta is made this morning. The veal is braised for four hours. Nothing is rushed. Nothing is skipped.

NYC's Italian renaissance — led by Carbone's theatrical service, Don Angie's creative Southern Italian, Via Carota's vegetable-forward neighbourhood simplicity, and Lilia's pasta mastery — has redefined what Italian-American dining means. It is no longer red sauce and garlic bread. It is the most exciting cuisine category in America right now.

Your trattoria succeeds when a guest walks in a stranger and walks out feeling like family.

Reference: Carbone (Greenwich Village) · Don Angie (West Village) · Via Carota (West Village) · I Sodi (West Village) · Lilia (Williamsburg) · Emmett's (SoHo) · L'Artusi (West Village) · Rezdôra (Flatiron) · Barbuto (West Village) · Cacio e Pepe (East Village)

RESTAURANT	NEIGHBOURHOOD	KNOWN FOR	WHAT WE BORROW
Carbone	Greenwich Village	Theatrical service, spicy rigatoni, old-school glamour	Table-side finishing, upsell culture, service theatre
Don Angie	West Village	Pinwheel lasagne, creative Southern Italian	Signature dish architecture, visual plating identity
Via Carota	West Village	Insalata verde, vegetable-forward, neighbourhood warmth	Vegetable as hero, salad as destination dish
I Sodi	West Village	Tuscan simplicity, handmade pasta, intimate rooms	Menu restraint — fewer dishes done perfectly
Lilia	Williamsburg	Sheep's milk agnolotti, pasta as fine dining	Pasta as centrepiece, texture contrast

Rezdôra	Flatiron	Emilian cuisine, tortellini en brodo, regional focus	Broth-based dishes, tableside pour theatre
L'Artusi	West Village	Wine bar energy, small plates evolving into mains	Pacing, wine pairing language, mid-service upsell
Barbuto	West Village	Jonathan Waxman's roast chicken, wood-fired	One hero dish philosophy — signature chicken
Cacio e Pepe	East Village	Simplicity at its finest — three ingredients	Perfect execution of simple dishes = profit
Emmett's	SoHo	Deep-dish pizza, Chicago meets NYC	Signature item identity, social media magnetism

Antipasti

6 Starters · NYC Trattoria Standard

Burrata with Heirloom Tomato & Basil Oil

Burrata con Pomodori Ereditati

GF VG VIA CAROTA DNA SIGNATURE

INGREDIENT	QTY	\$/UNIT
Burrata (fresh, 125g ball)	1 per cover	\$3.80
Heirloom tomatoes (mixed)	180g	\$1.20
Fresh basil	8 leaves	\$0.15
Extra virgin olive oil (good)	15ml	\$0.30
Maldon sea salt	pinch	\$0.05
Aged balsamic (Modena)	5ml	\$0.40
Sourdough crostini (2 pcs)	40g	\$0.20

- 1

Slice heirloom tomatoes — mix of thick rounds and wedges. Season with Maldon and olive oil. Rest 5 mins.
- 2

Build on plate: tomatoes first, burrata placed whole in centre, tear open tableside if possible.
- 3

Drizzle basil oil (blended basil + EVOO + salt) and aged balsamic in separate pools.
- 4

Finish with Maldon flakes, fresh basil leaves, black pepper. Crostini on the side.

ROOM TEMP

Food Cost: \$6.10 | Sell: \$18 | FC%: 34%

DAIRY

GLUTEN (crostini)

NYC Tip: Via Carota serves this as the vegetable hero — not a token starter. Use the best tomatoes you can find. Out of season? Roast cherry tomatoes slowly with thyme + olive oil at 150°C for 90 mins — better than any winter heirloom.

Beef Carpaccio, Capers, Grana Padano

Carpaccio di Manzo

GF CARBONE DNA

INGREDIENT	QTY	\$/UNIT
Beef eye fillet (sashimi-grade)	80g per cover	\$3.60
Grana Padano (shaved)	20g	\$0.60
Capers (Sicilian, salt-packed)	10g	\$0.25
Rocket (arugula)	25g	\$0.20
Lemon juice	½ lemon	\$0.15
EVOO	10ml	\$0.20
Dijon mustard emulsion	15ml	\$0.15

- 1

Freeze fillet 45 mins for clean slicing. Slice paper-thin on meat slicer or very sharp knife. Lay flat on chilled plate, overlapping slightly.
- 2

Brush immediately with dijon-lemon emulsion to prevent oxidation. Season with Maldon.
- 3

Top with rocket, shaved Grana Padano, capers. Drizzle EVOO and fresh lemon.
- 4

Serve immediately — carpaccio waits for no one.

CHILLED · SERVE FAST

Food Cost: \$5.15 | Sell: \$19 | FC%: 27%

DAIRY

MUSTARD

RAW BEEF

Polpette al Sugo — Braised Meatballs in San Marzano

Sunday Sauce Meatballs · Carbone Inspired

CARBONE DNA CROWD FAVOURITE

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER 4 BALLS)	\$/UNIT
Beef mince (80/20)	120g	\$1.10
Pork mince	60g	\$0.55
Pecorino Romano (grated)	20g	\$0.55
Fresh breadcrumbs (milk-soaked)	30g	\$0.10
Egg	1	\$0.35
San Marzano tomato sauce	180ml	\$0.60
Fresh basil + garlic	—	\$0.15

- 1

Mix beef, pork, Pecorino, soaked breadcrumbs, egg, garlic, salt. Do not overwork. Rest 20 mins cold.
- 2

Roll 60g balls. Sear in olive oil until deeply browned all sides — 8 mins.
- 3

Braise in San Marzano sauce + basil low and slow 45 mins covered. Sauce should cling.
- 4

Serve 4 balls with sauce pooled beneath. Fresh Pecorino + basil + grilled bread alongside.

165°F / 74°C INTERNAL

Food Cost: \$3.40 | Sell: \$16 | FC%: 21%

DAIRY GLUTEN EGG

NYC Tip: Carbone's meatballs are the most photographed dish in NYC Italian dining. The secret is the milk-soaked bread and the Sunday sauce that's been cooking since morning. Braise in bulk — these improve every day they sit in the sauce.

Insalata Verde — Shaved Fennel, Celery, Herbs

Via Carota's Famous Green Salad

GF VG DF VIA CAROTA DNA ICONIC

INGREDIENT	QTY	\$/UNIT
Fennel bulb (shaved paper-thin)	80g	\$0.50
Celery (sliced thin on bias)	40g	\$0.15
Little gem lettuce	60g	\$0.40
Fresh herbs (tarragon, chervil, mint)	10g	\$0.30
Lemon juice	20ml	\$0.15
EVOO	15ml	\$0.25
White wine vinegar	5ml	\$0.05

- 1

Shave fennel on mandoline — paper thin. Ice water 10 mins to crisp. Drain completely, pat dry.
- 2

Mix dressing: lemon, EVOO, vinegar, salt. Taste — should be bright and forward.
- 3

Toss greens, fennel, celery, herbs in dressing at last moment. Dress generously.
- 4

Pile high on plate — this salad should look abundant, not flat. Serve immediately.

DRESS TO ORDER Food Cost: \$1.80 | Sell: \$14 | FC%: 13%

NONE — naturally free from all major allergens

NYC Tip: Via Carota's insalata verde has been on the menu since 2014 and is still ordered at every table. The key is the lemon-forward dressing and herbs that most restaurants skip. Never dress ahead — it wilts in 3 minutes.

Fried Calamari, Lemon Aioli, Nduja Dipping Sauce

Calamari Fritti · Calabrian Spice

DF L'ARTUSI DNA

INGREDIENT	QTY	\$/UNIT
Squid (cleaned, tubes + tentacles)	150g	\$2.20
Semolina flour	60g	\$0.15
Plain flour	40g	\$0.08
Nduja sausage (spreadable)	30g	\$0.80
Egg yolks (for aioli)	2	\$0.70
Lemon (juice + zest)	1	\$0.25
Garlic (for aioli)	2 cloves	\$0.10

- 1

Score tubes, cut into rings. Pat completely dry — moisture = oil splatter. Season with salt.
- 2

Dredge in semolina-flour mix. Fry at 375°F/190°C in batches — 2-3 mins until golden. Drain immediately.
- 3

Nduja sauce: melt nduja in pan with splash olive oil + crushed tomato. Emulsify — rich, spicy, spreadable.
- 4

Serve immediately: calamari piled high, lemon aioli + nduja dipping sauce alongside, lemon wedge.

SERVE WITHIN 3 MINS OF FRY

Food Cost: \$4.28 | Sell: \$17 | FC%: 25%

SHELLFISH GLUTEN EGG PORK (nduja)

Cacio e Pepe Arancini — Fried Risotto Balls

Arancini al Cacio e Pepe

VGCACIO E PEPE DNABAR SNACK HERO

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER 3 BALLS)	\$/UNIT
Arborio rice (cooked risotto)	200g	\$0.40
Pecorino Romano	40g	\$1.10
Grana Padano	20g	\$0.60
Black pepper (cracked, generous)	3g	\$0.10
Mozzarella (cube for centre)	30g	\$0.60
Breadcrumbs (panko)	60g	\$0.15
Eggs (for crumbing)	2	\$0.70

- 1

Make cacio e pepe risotto: toast Arborio, cook with wine + stock. Finish with Pecorino, Grana, generous cracked black pepper. Cool completely.
- 2

Roll 70g balls. Press mozzarella cube in centre. Seal well.
- 3

Crumb: flour → egg wash → panko. Double crumb for extra crunch.
- 4

Fry 170°C for 4 mins until deep golden. Rest 1 min. Serve with whipped Pecorino + black pepper dipping sauce.

170 °C · 4 MINSFood Cost: \$3.65 | Sell: \$15 | FC%: 24%

DAIRYGLUTENEGG

NYC Tip: Arancini at the bar while guests wait for their table is the single best ROI move in the trattoria. \$15 × 40 covers at the bar = \$600 before they even sit down. L'Artusi does this brilliantly — the bar is always full at 6pm.

Pasta — Primi Piatti

5 of 10 Mains · Fresh Pasta For

Cacio e Pepe — Three-Ingredient Perfection

Tonnarelli Cacio e Pepe · East Village Standard

VG CACIO E PEPE NYC DNA SIGNATURE

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Tonnarelli or spaghetti	120g dried	\$0.45
Pecorino Romano (finely grated)	60g	\$1.65
Grana Padano (finely grated)	20g	\$0.60
Black pepper (Tellicherry, freshly cracked)	3g	\$0.12
Pasta water (starchy)	80ml	—

- 1 Toast cracked pepper in dry pan 60 seconds — blooms the flavour. Set aside.
- 2 Cook pasta in well-salted water. Reserve 200ml starchy pasta water before draining.
- 3 Mix Pecorino + Grana with 30ml warm pasta water to form a smooth paste — no lumps.
- 4 Toss drained pasta with pepper + pasta water in warm pan off heat. Add cheese paste gradually, tossing constantly. Emulsify — sauce should coat every strand. Add water as needed. Serve immediately in warm bowl.

OFF HEAT — NO SCRAMBLING

Food Cost: \$2.82 | Sell: \$22 | FC%: 13%

DAIRY GLUTEN

NYC Tip: The NYC standard is off-heat emulsification. Never add cheese to a hot pan — it breaks. Three ingredients, three things to get right: pasta water starch content, cheese-to-water ratio, and tossing speed. Train your team on this daily until it's muscle memory.

Rigatoni alla Vodka — Spicy Cream Tomato

Rigatoni alla Carbone · The Most Ordered Pasta in NYC

VG CARBONE DNA BEST SELLER

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Rigatoni (bronze die)	130g	\$0.50
San Marzano tomatoes (crushed)	120ml	\$0.55
Heavy cream	60ml	\$0.55
Vodka	30ml	\$0.40
Calabrian chilli (in oil)	8g	\$0.30
Shallots + garlic	30g	\$0.15
Grana Padano (finishing)	20g	\$0.60

- 1

Sauté shallots in olive oil until soft. Add Calabrian chilli — cook 2 mins.
- 2

Add vodka — flambe or cook off 2 mins. Add crushed San Marzano. Simmer 15 mins.
- 3

Add cream — simmer until slightly thickened. Season aggressively with salt.
- 4

Toss al dente rigatoni in sauce with pasta water to coat. Finish with Grana Padano, basil, chilli oil drizzle. Serve in warm bowl.

SAUCE: SIMMER 15 MINS

Food Cost: \$3.05 | Sell: \$24 | FC%: 13%

DAIRY GLUTEN ALCOHOL

NYC Tip: Carbone's spicy rigatoni has a 6-month waitlist partly because of this dish. Calabrian chilli is non-negotiable — it's sweeter and fruitier than regular chilli flakes. The cream is added after vodka burns off. Make the sauce in bulk; it improves overnight.

Sheep's Milk Agnolotti, Brown Butter, Sage

Agnolotti dal Plin · Lilia Inspired

VG LILIA DNA CHEF'S PRIDE

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
00 flour (pasta dough)	80g	\$0.20
Eggs (pasta dough)	2 yolks + 1 whole	\$1.05
Sheep's milk ricotta (filling)	80g	\$1.40
Pecorino (filling)	15g	\$0.40
Lemon zest (filling)	½ lemon	\$0.10
Unsalted butter	40g	\$0.55
Fresh sage leaves	6 leaves	\$0.20

- 1

Make pasta dough: flour + eggs, knead 10 mins, rest 30 mins wrapped. Roll thin (setting 6).
- 2

Filling: sheep's ricotta + Pecorino + lemon zest + salt + white pepper. Mix gently.
- 3

Pipe filling in dots, fold dough over, pinch between each — classic dal plin pinch. Cut into small pillows.
- 4

Cook 3 mins. Brown butter: foam butter until nutmeg aroma, add sage leaves, crisp. Toss agnolotti in brown butter, serve with Pecorino + lemon zest.

FRESH PASTA: 3 MINS

Food Cost: \$3.90 | Sell: \$26 | FC%: 15%

DAIRY GLUTEN EGG

Tortellini en Brodo — Pork & Parmigiano in Capon Broth

Tortellini in Brodo · Rezdôra Emilian Standard

REZDÔRA DNA TABLESIDE THEATRE

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
00 flour (pasta dough)	70g	\$0.18
Eggs (pasta dough)	2 yolks	\$0.70
Pork loin (filling)	50g	\$0.55
Mortadella (filling)	20g	\$0.40
Parmigiano Reggiano (filling)	20g	\$0.70
Capon or chicken broth (clarified)	300ml	\$0.80
Parmigiano (finishing, shaved)	15g	\$0.50

- 1 Filling: finely chop pork + mortadella, mix with Parmigiano, nutmeg, salt. Rest cold 1 hour.
- 2 Roll pasta thin. Cut 4cm circles. Fill with ½ tsp filling, fold into classic tortellini shape — fold in half, press, wrap around finger, pinch ends.
- 3 Clarify capon broth — should be crystal clear, deeply flavoured. Season perfectly.
- 4 Cook tortellini in broth 3 mins. Serve in warm bowl. Pour additional hot broth tableside from copper pot. Finish with shaved Parmigiano.

TABLESIDE BROTH POUR

Food Cost: \$3.83 | Sell: \$24 | FC%: 16%

DAIRY GLUTEN EGG PORK

NYC Tip: Rezdôra's tortellini en brodo is why people queue. The tableside pour from a copper pot elevates a simple dish into theatre. Your broth is your reputation — capon only, 6-hour cook, crystal clear. If your broth is cloudy, it's not ready.

Pappardelle, Slow Beef Ragù, Grana Padano

Pappardelle al Ragù di Manzo · I Sodi Tuscan Standard

I SODI DNA

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Fresh pappardelle (wide, egg pasta)	120g	\$0.60
Beef chuck (braised 4hrs)	100g	\$1.45
San Marzano tomatoes	80ml	\$0.35
Red wine (Chianti or Sangiovese)	60ml	\$0.40
Soffritto (carrot, celery, onion)	40g	\$0.20
Grana Padano (shaved)	25g	\$0.70
Fresh thyme + bay	—	\$0.10

- 1 Ragù: sear chuck in batches. Build soffritto. Deglaze with Chianti. Add tomatoes, stock, herbs. Braise covered at 150°C for 4 hours. Shred coarsely — keep some texture.
- 2 Cook fresh pappardelle 2 mins. Toss with ragù + splash pasta water — sauce should cling to every fold.
- 3 Plate in warm bowl. Finish: shaved Grana Padano, fresh thyme, drizzle of good EVOO.

RAGÙ: BRAISE 4 HRS

Food Cost: \$3.80 | Sell: \$25 | FC%: 15%

DAIRY GLUTEN EGG ALCOHOL

Secondi

5 of 10 Mains · Proteins, Roasts & Hearty Pla

Pollo al Mattone — Brick-Pressed Roast Chicken

Barbuto's Signature Dish · Jonathan Waxman Standard

GFDFBARBUTO DNABERO DISH

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Chicken (spatchcock, 1kg)	½ bird per cover	\$4.20
EVOO	30ml	\$0.50
Rosemary + thyme + garlic	—	\$0.20
Salsa verde (parsley, capers, anchovy)	40ml	\$0.55
Lemon	½	\$0.15
Chilli flakes	pinch	\$0.05

- 1

1 Spatchcock chicken. Dry brine overnight with salt + rosemary. Bring to room temp 30 mins before cooking.
- 2

2 Cast iron screaming hot. EVOO. Place chicken skin-side down. Press with heavy pan or brick. Cook 12 mins without moving.
- 3

3 Flip — roast in 220°C oven 8 mins until juices run clear. Rest 5 mins.
- 4

4 Serve half bird on board or plate. Generous salsa verde over. Lemon wedge. Finish at table with chilli oil drizzle.

INTERNAL: 165°F / 74°C

Food Cost: \$5.65 | Sell: \$34 | FC%: 17%

FISH (anchovy in salsa verde)

NYC Tip: Barbuto's roast chicken is the most famous single dish in NYC Italian dining. Jonathan Waxman has never taken it off the menu since 1998. The brick press on the skin is non-negotiable — creates the crackling skin that defines the dish. Your brick-pressed chicken IS your restaurant identity.

Osso Buco Milanese, Gremolata, Saffron Risotto

Osso Buco alla Milanese con Risotto Giallo

GF CARBONE DNA WEEKEND SPECIAL

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Veal osso buco (cross-cut shank, 350g)	1 piece	\$8.50
Soffritto (carrot, celery, onion)	80g	\$0.25
White wine + veal stock	200ml	\$0.70
San Marzano tomatoes	60ml	\$0.25
Gremolata (lemon, parsley, garlic)	15g	\$0.20
Arborio rice (risotto)	80g	\$0.35
Saffron (risotto)	pinch	\$0.80

- 1 Tie osso buco with string. Flour lightly, sear in olive oil until deep mahogany all sides.
- 2 Build soffritto in same pan. Deglaze with wine. Add stock + tomatoes + veal. Braise covered 2 hours at 160°C until falling from bone.
- 3 Saffron risotto: bloom saffron in warm stock. Make classic risotto — mantecatura with butter + Parmigiano.
- 4 Plate: risotto base, osso buco centred, braising jus reduced and spooned over. Gremolata scattered last. Serve immediately.

BRAISE 2 HRS · FALLING FROM BONE

Food Cost: \$11.05 | Sell: \$42 | FC%: 26%

DAIRY GLUTEN (flour dredge)

Branzino al Forno — Whole Roasted Sea Bass

Mediterranean Sea Bass · Herb-Crusted · L'Artusi Standard

GF DF L'ARTUSI DNA

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Whole branzino (500g, cleaned)	1 fish	\$9.50
Fresh herbs (rosemary, thyme, parsley)	—	\$0.25
Lemon (sliced for cavity)	1	\$0.25
EVOO	30ml	\$0.50
Capers + cherry tomatoes	40g	\$0.40
White wine (for pan)	50ml	\$0.35
Garlic (smashed)	3 cloves	\$0.10

- 1 Score fish 3 times each side. Season cavity and skin generously. Stuff cavity with lemon, herbs, garlic.
- 2 Roast on bed of cherry tomatoes + capers at 220°C for 18–22 mins until skin crisps and flesh pulls cleanly.
- 3 Rest 3 mins. Fillet tableside if service allows — presentation move.
- 4 Plate with roasted tomatoes + capers + pan juices + EVOO. Lemon wedge. Grilled bread alongside.

220°C · 18–22 MINS

Food Cost: \$11.35 | Sell: \$38 | FC%: 30%

FISH GLUTEN (bread)

Porchetta Arrosto — Slow-Roasted Pork Belly Roll

Porchetta di Ariccia · Roman Street Food Elevated

GFDFDON ANGIE DNA

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Pork belly (skin-on, rolled)	180g	\$2.25
Fennel fronds + pollen	10g	\$0.30
Rosemary + garlic + chilli	—	\$0.20
White bean purée	80ml	\$0.40
Roasted fennel (side)	80g	\$0.45
Salsa verde	30ml	\$0.35
Apple cider vinegar (jus)	20ml	\$0.10

- 1Butterfly pork belly. Rub inner face with fennel pollen, rosemary, garlic, chilli, salt. Roll tight, tie every 2cm. Dry brine uncovered overnight.
- 2Roast at 150°C for 3 hours. Blast at 230°C for 20 mins — crackling must be glass-like.
- 3Rest 15 mins. Slice 3cm rounds.
- 4Plate: white bean purée base, porchetta slices fanned, roasted fennel, salsa verde. Deglazed pan jus with cider vinegar alongside.

150°C 3HRS → 230°C BLAST

Food Cost: \$4.05 | Sell: \$32 | FC%: 13%

PORK

Bistecca alla Fiorentina — T-Bone for Two

Florentine T-Bone · Shared Plate · Carbone Big Table Energy

GFDFCARBONE DNATABLE THEATRE

INGREDIENT	QTY (FOR 2)	\$/UNIT
T-bone steak (1kg, 45-day dry-aged)	1 steak	\$28.00
Rosemary salt	5g	\$0.10
EVOO (finishing)	20ml	\$0.35
Lemon	1	\$0.25
Roasted cannellini beans	120g	\$0.50
Grilled radicchio	80g	\$0.60

- 1Bring steak to full room temp — 1 hour minimum. Season only with rosemary salt.
- 2Grill on highest heat possible — charcoal preferred. 4 mins each side for rare. Stand on bone for 3 mins to cook through to bone.
- 3Rest on board 8 mins minimum. Do not cover — let it breathe.
- 4Carve tableside. Slice off fillet and striploin from bone. Fan on warm plate. Drizzle finishing EVOO + lemon. Cannellini beans + grilled radicchio alongside. Maldon on the slice.

INTERNAL: 52°C / 125°F RARE

Food Cost: \$29.80 | Sell: \$95 (for 2) | FC%: 31%

NONE

NYC Tip: The bistecca for two is your highest revenue item and your best marketing. When it comes out on a board and gets carved tableside, every table in the room sees it. Carbone does this — the dish sells itself. Price it at \$95 for two. At 20% of tables ordering it, the numbers change your whole night.

Dolci

4 Desserts · Classic Italian Endings

Tiramisù — Classic, Tableside
Tiramisù al Cucchiaino · Individual Copper Pot Service

VG EVERY NYC TRATTORIA DNA NON-NEGOTIABLE

INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Mascarpone	80g	\$1.20
Egg yolks	2	\$0.70
Caster sugar	30g	\$0.08
Savoiardi (ladyfinger biscuits)	4	\$0.40
Espresso (strong, cooled)	60ml	\$0.25
Dark rum or Marsala	15ml	\$0.30
Dutch cocoa (finishing)	5g	\$0.10

- 1

Whisk yolks + sugar over bain marie until ribbon stage — thick, pale, 65°C. Cool.
- 2

Fold mascarpone into yolk mixture in 3 additions. Light touch — airy, not dense.
- 3

Dip savoiardi briefly in espresso + rum. Layer in individual serving vessel. Mascarpone layer. Repeat. Refrigerate minimum 4 hours — overnight preferred.
- 4

Dust with cocoa heavily tableside using a fine sieve. This is the moment — do it in front of the guest.

SERVE CHILLED · DUST TABLESIDE

Food Cost: \$3.03 | Sell: \$14 | FC%: 22%

DAIRY EGG GLUTEN ALCOHOL

NYC Tip: Individual copper pots or glass vessels dusted tableside are standard at every serious NYC Italian. The cocoa dusting takes 8 seconds and is the single most photographed moment of dessert service. Never pre-dust.

Panna Cotta, Amarena Cherries, Hazelnut Praline

Panna Cotta al Cioccolato Bianco · Don Angie Inspired

GF	VG	DON ANGIE DNA
INGREDIENT	QTY (PER COVER)	\$/UNIT
Heavy cream	150ml	\$1.40
White chocolate (Valrhona)	30g	\$0.85
Gelatin sheets	1.5 sheets	\$0.20
Vanilla bean	¼ pod	\$0.40
Amarena cherries (in syrup)	4 cherries + 20ml syrup	\$0.55
Hazelnut praline (crushed)	15g	\$0.45

- 1 Bloom gelatin in cold water. Heat cream + vanilla to 70°C — do not boil. Add white chocolate, stir until melted. Add squeezed gelatin.
- 2 Strain into moulds. Refrigerate minimum 4 hours until set but slightly wobbly in centre.
- 3 Unmould onto cold plate (or serve in glass). Spoon amarena cherries + syrup alongside.
- 4 Scatter hazelnut praline just before service for crunch contrast. Serve cold.

SET 4 HRS MINIMUM

Food Cost: \$3.85 | Sell: \$13 | FC%: 30%

DAIRY TREE NUTS (hazelnut)

Cannoli — Fried to Order, Filled to Order

Cannoli Siciliani · Never Pre-Filled

VG	BAR & DESSERT HERO	
INGREDIENT	QTY (PER 2 CANNOLI)	\$/UNIT
Cannoli shells (house-made or quality imported)	2 shells	\$0.60
Sheep's milk ricotta (strained overnight)	80g	\$1.40
Icing sugar	20g	\$0.08
Orange zest	½ orange	\$0.10
Candied orange peel (ends)	10g	\$0.25
Dark chocolate chips (in filling)	15g	\$0.35
Pistachio dust (ends, NF sub: pumpkin seed)	8g	\$0.30

- 1 Strain ricotta overnight through muslin — remove all moisture. Mix with icing sugar, orange zest, chocolate chips.
- 2 Pipe filling to order — never pre-fill (shells go soggy). Use a wide star tip for presentation.
- 3 Dip ends in crushed pistachio (or pumpkin seed for nut-free) + candied orange peel.
- 4 Dust with icing sugar. Serve immediately on marble slab or slate. Two per serve.

FILL TO ORDER · NEVER PRE-FILL

Food Cost: \$3.08 | Sell: \$12 | FC%: 26%

DAIRY GLUTEN EGG (shell)

Affogato — Vanilla Gelato, Double Espresso

Affogato al Caffè · L'Artusi Bar Standard

GFVG L'ARTUSI DNABEST MARGIN

INGREDIENT	QTY	\$/UNIT
House vanilla gelato (or quality imported)	2 scoops (100g)	\$1.20
Double espresso (freshly pulled)	60ml	\$0.45
Amaretto (optional, served alongside)	30ml	\$0.60
Biscotti (house-made, 1 piece)	1	\$0.25

- 1

Chill serving glass or copper cup in freezer — cold vessel is essential.
- 2

Two scoops gelato in cold vessel. Pull espresso fresh — must be served immediately.
- 3

Pour espresso tableside over gelato. Present amaretto in small shot glass alongside.
- 4

Biscotti on the saucer. Serve immediately — affogato waits for nothing.

POUR TABLESIDE · SERVE IMMEDIATELY

Food Cost: \$2.50 | Sell: \$12 | FC%: 21%

DAIRYGLUTEN (biscotti)ALCOHOL (opt)

NYC Tip: *The affogato is your best margin dessert and the fastest to execute. The tableside pour is non-negotiable — it's theatre. L'Artusi sells 40-50 affogatos on a busy Friday. At \$12 and \$2.50 food cost, that's \$475 profit on one item on one night.*

Bevande

8 Drinks · Wine + Cocktails + Non-Alcohol

Negroni Sbagliato

Campari · Sweet Vermouth · Prosecco

1oz Campari + 1oz sweet vermouth + top with Prosecco. Orange half-wheel. Rocks glass. The aperitivo standard — sell 2 before every table sits down.

\$3.50 cost | \$16 sell | 22% FC

Aperol Spritz

Aperol · Prosecco · Soda · Orange

3oz Prosecco + 2oz Aperol + splash soda. Large wine glass, lots of ice, orange slice. The most photographed aperitivo in NYC. Always on special at happy hour — drives early seating revenue.

\$2.80 cost | \$14 sell | 20% FC

Limoncello Spritz

House Limoncello · Prosecco · Lemon

Make limoncello in-house (lemon zest + vodka + simple syrup, 2-week infusion). 2oz limoncello + Prosecco top + lemon twist. Cost almost nothing. Premium price — house-made story.

\$1.90 cost | \$14 sell | 14% FC

Carafe House Chianti

Sangiovese · Tuscany · 500ml Carafe

House red in a 500ml carafe — the trattoria DNA. Price at \$28. Feels generous, high margin. Sangiovese or Montepulciano. Every table should order one. Train staff to suggest it with pasta.

\$8.00 cost | \$28 sell | 29% FC

Italian Americano

Campari · Sweet Vermouth · Soda — No Alcohol Version Available

Classic pre-dinner. Lower ABV than Negroni. Non-alcoholic version: Fever-Tree Italian blood orange soda + splash of bitters. Sell to the non-drinker at the table — they feel included.

\$2.20 cost | \$13 sell | 17% FC

San Pellegrino Still + Sparkling

750ml Bottle Service · Table Water Standard

Always offer San Pellegrino by name — never just "still or sparkling." Brand recognition = premium perception. 750ml bottle \$9 sell. Table of 4 = \$9-18 in water. Over 60 covers = \$135-270 water revenue. Never ignore it.

\$2.50 cost | \$9 sell | 28% FC

Espresso + Doppio

Post-Dinner · No Decaf Apology

Every Italian meal ends with espresso. Train staff to offer it as standard — not as a question. "Can I bring you an espresso to finish?" not "Would you like anything else?" The framing changes the yes rate from 30% to 65%.

\$0.45 cost | \$5 sell | 9% FC

Amaro Montenegro Digestivo

Post-Dinner Ritual · Complimentary or Charged

Offer a small amaro pour at the end of service. Complimentary to regulars — builds loyalty. Charged at \$12 to new guests. The gesture of offering it says "you are in a real Italian restaurant." Carbone does this religiously.

\$1.80 cost | \$12 sell | 15% FC

KITCHEN DESIGN

The NYC Trattoria Kitchen Layout

Every NYC Italian kitchen is built around the pasta station. Everything else — grill, sauté, fryer — supports it. Carbone, Lilia, and Via Carota all share the same DNA: pasta is made fresh, pasta is served fast, pasta is the heart of the operation.

STATION LAYOUT (60-SEAT TRATTORIA)

- ▣ **Grill Station** — Char-grill + flat top; bistecca, pollo al mattone, branzino
- ▣ **Pasta Station** — 6-burner + pasta insert; heart of the kitchen; highest traffic
- ▣ **Cold Station (Garde Manger)** — carpaccio, insalata verde, burrata, chilled starters
- ▣ **Sauté Station** — braises, sauces, risotto; osso buco, ragù reheating
- ▣ **Fry Station** — calamari, arancini, cannoli shells; separate fryer per product
- ▣ **Pastry/Dessert Station** — tiramisù, panna cotta, cannoli filling; cold zone
- ▣ **Pasta Making (prep area)** — sheeter, roller, bench; produce daily before service

EQUIPMENT LIST — NYC STANDARD

- ✓ Pasta sheeter (Imperia or Marcato)
- ✓ 6-burner commercial range
- ✓ Char-grill or wood-fired oven
- ✓ Pasta inserts (1 per burner)
- ✓ Deep fryer (twin basket)
- ✓ Bain marie station (cold)
- ✓ Deli slicer (carpaccio)
- ✓ Copper pots (tablesides service)
- ✓ Pass rail with heat lamp
- ✓ Walk-in cold (pasta dough, braises)
- ✓ Espresso machine (La Marzocco or Nuova Simonelli)

SERVICE SCRIPTS — NYC TRATTORIA STANDARD

GREETING + APERITIVO SELL

"Welcome to [Restaurant]. I'm [Name] and I'll be taking care of you tonight.

Can I start you with something to drink while you settle in? We have a lovely Aperol Spritz, a Negroni Sbagliato — or if you prefer, our house-made limoncello spritz is very popular right now.

For the table, would you like still or sparkling San Pellegrino?"

Target: Every table orders aperitivo + water before menus open

PASTA UPSELL SCRIPT

"Our pastas are all made fresh this morning. I'd especially recommend the rigatoni alla vodka — it's our most popular dish, and the cacio e pepe if you want something classic.

The tortellini en brodo is our kitchen's signature — the broth is poured tableside. It's a bit of a moment."

Name the tableside broth pour — guests self-select the theatre

BISTECCA SELL SCRIPT

"If you're considering sharing, our bistecca alla Fiorentina is a 45-day dry-aged T-bone for two — we carve it tableside on a board.

It's genuinely one of those dishes. It's priced at \$95 for the two of you."

[Pause. Let them decide. Do not fill the silence.]

Pause after the sell — silence closes the deal

DESSERT + ESPRESSO CLOSE

"Can I bring you our tiramisù? It's made in-house and I'll dust the cocoa at your table.

And let me bring you an espresso to finish — or if you'd like to end Italian style, a small amaro."

Never ask "would you like anything else?" — suggest specific items

THE NYC TRATTORIA SERVICE PHILOSOPHY

Carbone Rule: Every table is a performance. Your service is part of the dish.

Via Carota Rule: The salad gets the same attention as the bistecca. Every dish matters.

Lilia Rule: The pasta station is the heart. If pasta is slow, everything is slow. Staff rotation through pasta station is mandatory.

DAILY PREP · RETENTION SYSTEM · STAFF FORECAST

DAILY PREP SCHEDULE

7:00 AM — MORNING PREP

- ☐ Make pasta dough (pappardelle, tonnarelli, sheets for agnolotti)
- ☐ Start beef ragù braising (4 hours minimum)
- ☐ Braise osso buco (2 hours minimum)
- ☐ Make tiramisù (must set 4 hours)
- ☐ Make panna cotta — refrigerate
- ☐ Strain ricotta for cannoli overnight

10:00 AM — MID PREP

- ☐ Roll and cut pasta sheets — cover, refrigerate
- ☐ Make cacio e pepe arancini risotto — cool
- ☐ Prepare calamari (score, dry, ready to dredge)
- ☐ Make vodka sauce base (finish to order)
- ☐ Make San Marzano sauce for polpette
- ☐ Prep soffritto, mise en place all stations

2:00 PM — SERVICE PREP

- ☐ Roll arancini — crumb, refrigerate
- ☐ Fold agnolotti, tortellini — lay on semolina trays
- ☐ Slice beef fillet for carpaccio (freeze 45 mins)
- ☐ Marinate porchetta if cooking tonight
- ☐ Set up dessert station — portion tiramisù, dust order
- ☐ Brief FOH on specials + 86 list

5:00 PM — PRE-SERVICE

- ☐ Taste everything — final seasoning check
- ☐ Fire broth for tortellini service
- ☐ Confirm bistecca dry-aged, at room temp
- ☐ Arancini: fry one tester — check crust + fill
- ☐ Check pasta water is at rolling boil, salted
- ☐ All copper pots on pass for tableside service

CUSTOMER RETENTION SYSTEM

DAY OF VISIT

- Name-collect on reservation
- Greet by name on arrival
- Note dietary preferences in system
- Complimentary amaro for special occasions
- Manager stops by every table once

24 HRS AFTER VISIT

- Text/email: "Thank you for dining with us"
- Include the chef's recipe for one dish they ordered
- Soft invitation: "Next visit, try the bistecca"
- Note: who ordered what, for next visit recognition

30 DAYS LATER

- "We've added a new pasta to the menu — thought of you"
- Monthly newsletter: new seasonal dish + wine pairing
- Birthday recognition: complimentary dessert offer
- Regulars get first booking for new menu launches

STAFF FORECAST — 60-SEAT TRATTORIA · NYC DINNER SERVICE

ROLE	HEADCOUNT	HOURLY RATE (US)	WEEKLY HOURS	WEEKLY COST
Head Chef / Exec Chef	1	\$28–35/hr	50 hrs	\$1,400–1,750
Sous Chef	1	\$22–26/hr	45 hrs	\$990–1,170
Pasta Chef (dedicated)	1	\$20–24/hr	40 hrs	\$800–960
Grill/Sauté Cook	1	\$18–22/hr	40 hrs	\$720–880

Garde Manger	1	\$16–20/hr	35 hrs	\$560–700
Dishwasher/Prep	2	\$15–17/hr	35 hrs	\$1,050–1,190
Front of House Manager	1	\$22–28/hr	45 hrs	\$990–1,260
Servers (dinner service)	4	\$8–12/hr + tips	25 hrs	\$800–1,200 + tips
Barista / Bar	1	\$15–18/hr	30 hrs	\$450–540
Host	1	\$16–18/hr	25 hrs	\$400–450
Total Weekly Labour				\$7,160–8,900
Monthly Labour (est.)				\$28,600–35,600

Labour Target: NYC trattoria labour should run 28–32% of revenue. At \$350K/month revenue target, your labour ceiling is \$98K–\$112K/month. Use the KitchenFounder Labour Planner tool to model your specific numbers. Dedicated pasta chef is your most important hire — they are your product.

Financial Model

NYC Trattoria — Year 1 P&L Benchmark

Based on 60-seat dinner-only service, 5 nights per week, \$85 average spend per cover. NYC benchmark from Lilia, Don Angie, and Sodi revenue models.

Category	Monthly (USD)	Annual (USD)	% Revenue
Revenue — Food	\$252,000	\$3,024,000	72%
Revenue — Beverage	\$98,000	\$1,176,000	28%
TOTAL REVENUE	\$350,000	\$4,200,000	100%
Cost of Goods — Food (28%)	(\$70,560)	(\$846,720)	28%
Cost of Goods — Beverage (22%)	(\$21,560)	(\$258,720)	6%
GROSS PROFIT	\$257,880	\$3,094,560	74%
Labour (BOH + FOH, 31%)	(\$108,500)	(\$1,302,000)	31%
Rent (NYC avg for 60-seat)	(\$35,000)	(\$420,000)	10%
Utilities + Insurance	(\$12,000)	(\$144,000)	3.4%
Marketing + Supplies + Misc	(\$8,500)	(\$102,000)	2.4%
EBITDA	\$93,880	\$1,126,560	26.8%
Depreciation + Interest	(\$18,000)	(\$216,000)	5%
NET PROFIT	\$75,880	\$910,560	21.7%

DAILY COVERS TARGET

120

2 turns x 60 seats
at \$85 avg spend

FOOD COST TARGET

28%

Pasta = 13–16% FC
Bistecca carries avg up

BREAKEVEN POINT

\$245K

Monthly revenue
to cover all fixed costs

KEY REVENUE LEVERS — NYC TRATTORIA

- **Aperitivo sell rate:** If 70% of tables order a \$14–16 aperitivo, that adds \$58K/year on a 60-seat restaurant

→ **Bistecca conversion:** 20% of tables ordering \$95 bistecca adds \$126K/year

→ **Water revenue:** Every table ordering San Pellegrino at \$9 adds \$32K/year
- **Espresso close:** 65% close rate on espresso at \$5 adds \$16K/year

→ **Second turn:** Moving from 1.5 turns to 2 turns per night adds \$175K/year

→ **Amaro upsell:** 40% of tables ordering \$12 amaro adds \$30K/year

THIS GUIDE COMES WITH 22 FREE TOOLS

- ✓ Food Cost Calculator

✓ Break-Even Calculator

✓ Labour Planner

✓ Cash Flow Forecast

✓ Menu Engineering Matrix

✓ Daily Prep Sheet Generator

✓ Waste Tracker
- ✓ Temperature Log (HACCP)

✓ Shift Handover Report

✓ Restaurant Opening Checklist

✓ Pre-Opening Timeline

✓ Staff Onboarding Kit

✓ Health Inspection Prep

✓ Lease Negotiation Guide
- ✓ Supplier Negotiation Kit

✓ Opening Week Runsheet

✓ Competitor Analysis Tool

✓ Investor Pitch Builder

✓ Social Media Launch Playbook

✓ Liquor License Guide

✓ KitchenFounder OS App

✓ Roster Builder

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